would have to die, even after the Wehrmacht was defeated, before this horrible war would draw to a close? Maybe it was what they deserved. The problem was that someone she loved was here and he might not survive the bombing.

Léa and André believed it was only a matter of time before the Allies attacked Berlin on a scale never seen before. Rose could almost feel the danger in the air like the pulse of an approaching electrical storm. She had to get André out of Berlin before it arrived.

* * *

Later, on the train as the sisters made the journey back to Glashütte, Rose told Léa about her idea to get André transferred.

"You will ask Reinhardt?" Léa said, incredulous.

"It can't hurt to try."

"Do you not worry that this will bind you even more to him?"

Rose looked out the window.

"Remember how we talked about—"

"And you said we have to make choices." She turned back. "Sometimes terrible ones, for the greater good. If it comes to that, I'm ready. But so far it's not like that. He's lonely, and since he's in a position where he can't talk to anyone, he wants me there to listen."

Léa leaned back on the wooden seat. Rose could see by her raised eyebrows that she worried about where this latest twist in her relationship with Reinhardt would lead.

"Do you remember when it was only about getting food vouchers to save Maria's baby and help the Polish women?" She leaned forward, lowering her voice. "Maybe you think all he wants is for you to listen. But what if you're wrong?" She pressed her lips together. "Are you prepared to deal with the consequences?"

"If it saves André's life, yes."

"You're still madly in love with him after a year apart?"

Rose smiled. "Yes. And I'm worried. He told me that the foreign workers aren't allowed in the bomb shelters. How will he survive the bombing campaigns the Allies will carry out? André said they will destroy Berlin and everything in it."